Forum:	Special Political and Decolonization Committee (GA4)
Issue:	Addressing the Issue of Ensuring stability in regions affected by protracted and frozen conflicts
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Position:	Co-Chair

Introduction

Frozen and protracted conflicts are prevalent in different parts of the world and constitute an enormous challenge to international peace and security. Such conflicts tend to displace large masses of people, create humanitarian emergencies, and increase insecurity among the civilian population. [1] Disruptions of medical care, education, and other critical services as well as economic deterioration become inevitable during such conflicts. [2]Therefore, not only international but also regional stability suffers, making sustainable development and peaceful coexistence more complicated than before.

It should be noted that despite their similarities, these two types of conflicts differ greatly from each other. Protracted conflicts are long-standing and complicated disputes which exist over decades and are usually associated with profound political, ethnic, religious, cultural, and socio-economic rifts. These conflicts are defined by the ongoing violence, failure of peace initiatives, and inability to reach a political agreement between conflicting sides. On the other hand, frozen conflicts are those situations in which large-scale armed conflicts cease but no peace agreement is reached. [3]

In terms of their influence, the aforementioned conflicts go beyond the borders where they take place. They become the cause of migration and refugee flows, affect international trade and investments, pose threats to regional security, and can engage neighboring countries or great powers who pursue opposing geopolitical interests.[4] Moreover, in cases of prolonged instability in a region, numerous grounds emerge for the development of organized crime, terrorism and violations of international humanitarian law and human rights conventions. Therefore, frozen and protracted conflicts are a

[1] United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees. "Global Trends." *Unhcr*, 6 Apr. 2024, https://www.unhcr.org/global-trends.

[2] ICRC. "International Committee of the Red Cross." ICRC, 31 Aug. 2016. https://www.icrc.org/en

[3] Bakar, Ergun. "Frozen Conflicts: Definition, Conceptual Context & Why It Matters - TRT World Research Centre." *TRT World Research Centre*, 4 May 2026, https://researchcentre.trtworld.com/dictionary/frozen-conflicts/.

[4] "Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs." https://dppa.un.org/en

crucial issue for the international community that requires joint diplomatic, humanitarian and peacebuilding measures.

The discussion of frozen and protracted conflicts is particularly important now that geopolitical tensions undermine the rules-based international order. The prevention of further aggravation of unresolved conflicts, the protection of civilians and peaceful conflict resolution are crucial in establishing sustainable peace and international stability. Within the framework of the conference theme, the discussed problem is especially relevant since it demonstrates the necessity of a multilateral approach to dealing with complex security issues. While considering international political and security affairs on behalf of GA4, delegates are welcome to consider humanitarian, political and legal aspects of frozen and protracted conflicts and develop respective solutions. [5]

Key Terms and Definitions

Buffer Zone

A buffer zone is an area separating opposing forces or territories, intended to reduce direct contact and the risk of renewed hostilities.[6]

Ceasefire

To stop the war, peace processes should contain mechanisms and approaches that help either prevent or handle violence. Ceasefires may serve as the beginning of comprehensive peace talks in civil wars. A ceasefire is one of the very first issues that combatants seek to talk about in their negotiation process. Partial, temporary, local or humanitarian ceasefires are becoming increasingly common as means of helping de-escalate conflict and minimize violence in situations when comprehensive negotiations are not possible yet. [7]

Conflict Transformation

Conflict Transformation is an active, holistic process. Recognizing that conflict has the potential to bring about a productive change is the first step in this perspective. It is an attempt to make use of the energy generated by conflict for a better reconstitution of the systems and relationships.[8]

Confidence Building Measures

Military Confidence-Building Measures (CBMs) are an important tool in the arsenal of conflict prevention and settlement. Actions carried out unilaterally, bilaterally, or multilaterally by national

[5] United Nations. "UN Charter." 1945. https://www.un.org/en/about-us/un-charter

[6] Centre, UNESCO World Heritage. "Buffer Zones - Glossary."https://whc.unesco.org/en/glossary/199

[7] "Ceasefires and Security Arrangements | UN Peacemaker." Sept. 2022. https://peacemaker.un.org/en/thematic-areas/ceasefires-security-arrangements

[8] Pollack, Jeremy. "What Is Conflict Transformation? Definition & 5 Historical Examples - Pollack Peacebuilding Systems." *Pollack Peacebuilding Systems*, 16 Aug. 2024, pollackpeacebuilding.com/blog/conflict-transformation/.

defense agencies are known as military CBMs. Such actions can include military restrictions, cooperation and integration, communication and coordination, observation and verification, training, and education, among others.[9]

Everyday Peace Initiatives

Everyday peace initiatives are efforts led by communities to decrease conflict and promote tolerance in deeply divided societies.

De Facto State

Political entities that exercise control over a territory but lack widespread international recognition are called de facto states. This is because these governments appear to violate the territorial integrity principle and the doctrine of border fixity in various ways. The very fact of the existence of de facto states can be considered a problem for the entire system of modern states.[10]

Frozen Conflict

Frozen Conflicts denote prolonged conflicts that are unresolved and often involve periods of relative calm punctuated by occasional violence. Typically, such conflicts are hard to solve through diplomacy, leading to occasional military flare-ups. The most notable thing about these conflicts is their lack of peace treaties, which makes them perpetually hostile and destabilizing in the regions where they occur. Such conflicts can significantly influence international relations and the geopolitics of the region.[11]

Peacebuilding

Peace-building attempts to address the root causes of conflict, prompting people to solve their disputes through peaceful means and lay down the groundwork for avoiding future violence.[12]

Peacekeeping

Peacekeeping can be defined as the measures taken to preserve or restore peace in conflict zones. In peacekeeping, there is an attempt at creating dialogue between cultures and addressing social and humanitarian problems for the promotion of stability. Peacekeeping entails protecting civilians and helping in political processes while providing humanitarian assistance to violence-ridden regions. [13]

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[9] **"**Military Confidence Building Measures | United Nations Office for Disarmament Affairs." *Unoda.org*, 2025, disarmament.unoda.org/en/our-work/cross-cutting-issues/military-confidence-building-measures.

[10] Mylonas, Harris. "De Facto States Unbound - PONARS Eurasia." *PONARS Eurasia*, 2025, www.ponarseurasia.org/de-facto-states-unbound/ .

[11] ---. "Frozen Conflicts: Definition, Conceptual Context & Why It Matters - TRT World Research Centre." *TRT World Research Centre*, 4 May 2026, https://researchcentre.trtworld.com/dictionary/frozen-conflicts/

[12] Conciliation Resources. "What Is Peacebuilding? | Conciliation Resources." 2024. https://www.c-r.org/who-we-are/why-peacebuilding/what-peacebuilding

[13] "What is Peacekeeping." 2024. https://www.unesco.org/en/query-list/p/peacekeeping

Protracted Crisis

Protracted crises are cases in which large parts of the population become very vulnerable to hunger, disease, and disruption to their ability to earn a living. Malnutrition becomes serious, chronic, and can be substantially higher than in other developing countries. In 2023, 36 countries were suffering from prolonged food crises, as per the Global Report on Food Crises (GRFC) 2024.

Self-Determination

The idea of self-determination can be seen as the process whereby a people with a certain national identity become a nation-state and choose their government. The idea of self-determination in politics can be traced back to its development as an outcome of nationalism. Nationalism emerged from the ideas of the American and French Revolutions. The Allied nations acknowledged self-determination as a means of achieving peace in World War I. [14]

Territorial Integrity

The principle that lies at the heart of present-day international law is territorial integrity. This principle is responsible for protecting the territorial integrity of states and prohibiting external interference aimed at dismemberment, annexation, or any other change of boundaries through force. The rule is connected with two principles: the sovereign equality of states and the prohibition of the use of force. Territorial integrity is considered one of the major barriers to territorial acquisition in the contemporary system of international law. [15]

Background Information

Historical Background

Most of the governments which achieved their independence following the disintegration of the Soviet Union at the end of 1991 found themselves facing frozen conflicts. Some of those conflicts included Transnistria in Moldova, Nagorno-Karabakh in Azerbaijan, and Abkhazia and South Ossetia in Georgia. These conflicts largely involved ethnic minorities seeking changes to their political status following independence. The conflicts in Donetsk and Luhansk in Ukraine emerged later, in 2014, rather than immediately following the dissolution of the Soviet Union.

Historical Causes

The dissolution of the Soviet Union created several newly independent states whose internationally recognised borders did not necessarily reflect the ethnic, linguistic and political divisions of their populations. During the Soviet period, administrative boundaries had been established between

[14] The Editors of Encyclopaedia Britannica. *Self-Determination | Definition, History, & Facts*. *Encyclopædia Britannica*, 2019, https://www.britannica.com/topic/self-determination.

[15] Santos, Edmarverson A. "Principle of Territorial Integrity in International Law." 5 Mar. 2026.https://www.diplomacyandlaw.com/post/principle-of-territorial-integrity-in-international-law

different republics and autonomous regions. Following independence, disagreements concerning these boundaries and the political status of minority populations contributed to increasing tensions.

However, ethnic differences alone cannot adequately explain the emergence of these conflicts. Political competition, unequal access to institutions, historical grievances and disagreements over the distribution of power also contributed to instability. In some cases, local political leaders mobilised existing divisions to strengthen their demands for autonomy or independence. The absence of effective institutions capable of addressing these grievances increased the likelihood of political disagreements developing into armed confrontations.

The relationship between political exclusion and conflict is particularly important. According to the United Nations and World Bank (2018), grievances arising from unequal access to political power, security, justice and economic opportunities can contribute to violent conflict, especially when institutions lack the capacity or legitimacy to address them. Consequently, understanding the historical origins of a frozen conflict requires an examination not only of territorial disagreements but also of the political and social conditions that allowed those disagreements to escalate.

The Persistence of Frozen and Protracted Conflicts

One of the most important characteristics of frozen and protracted conflicts is the difficulty of achieving a permanent political settlement. Even when armed hostilities decrease, the fundamental disagreements that initially caused the conflict may remain unresolved. This can create a situation in which neither side is willing to accept the political demands of the other, while neither possesses the military or diplomatic means to impose a definitive settlement.

Over time, the continuation of an unresolved conflict can also create new political and economic circumstances that make negotiations increasingly difficult. Authorities operating within disputed territories may establish administrative institutions, security structures and economic arrangements that depend on the continuation of the existing situation. As these structures become more established, their representatives may become reluctant to accept agreements requiring substantial political or institutional changes.

Furthermore, prolonged separation between communities can weaken opportunities for cooperation and mutual understanding. Restrictions on movement, limited economic interaction and competing historical narratives may reinforce distrust, particularly among generations that have experienced little direct contact with the opposing community.

As a result, the passage of time does not necessarily bring conflicting parties closer to an agreement. In certain circumstances, it can deepen existing divisions and create additional obstacles to reconciliation. This explains why a conflict may remain relatively inactive militarily while continuing to represent a significant challenge to regional stability.

Testimonies of People Living in Areas Affected by Protracted and Frozen Conflicts

Olga is one of the 3.4 million people affected by an almost forgotten conflict in eastern Ukraine. "In 2014, violence started in my hometown. My hometown is now in a territory in Ukraine that is outside the control of the government," explains Olga, aged 33. "With my husband, children, and me, we had to leave for somewhere else. We ultimately settled in Slavyansk." Olga, who is the mother of two sons aged five and six respectively, regrets not being able to communicate freely with her relatives who remain in the territories outside the control of the government. "We do not see them as often as we would wish. That's because we have to cross the checkpoint," she elaborates. Despite the difficulties encountered by Olga after displacement, several humanitarian agencies have been very helpful.

Olga's experience demonstrates that the consequences of unresolved conflicts are not limited to military operations. The separation of families, restrictions on movement and uncertainty regarding future living conditions can continue long after individuals have escaped the immediate dangers of armed confrontation.

The testimony also demonstrates how territorial divisions can affect everyday life. Individuals living on opposite sides of a ceasefire line or disputed boundary may encounter administrative obstacles that prevent them from maintaining personal relationships, accessing property or travelling freely. These restrictions can gradually transform temporary displacement into a long-term condition, especially when no political settlement provides a clear possibility of return.

The testimony dates from 2018 and therefore describes conditions preceding Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022. Nevertheless, it illustrates the humanitarian consequences of the earlier, prolonged phase of the conflict.

Challenges and Risks

Effects of prolonged and frozen crises and disasters affect lives and the achievement of future growth in the development of states. In more detail, prolonged crises have become the norm, and additional challenges have emerged. Over 25% of the world's population lives in countries and regions affected by extended conflict and disaster. By 2030, over 60% of people experiencing poverty in the world were projected to be living in conditions of prolonged crisis. Fragile and environmentally vulnerable countries, or both, were estimated to account for 90% of poor people.

Protracted crisis situations face much higher levels of hunger and malnutrition, with undernourishment three times higher than elsewhere. These conflicts are becoming increasingly regionalised, complex, and intractable. More than 65 million people were displaced across the globe in 2015, the highest number since the end of World War II at the time. The average time that refugees spent displaced in major crises was estimated at 20 years.

Cumulative Humanitarian Consequences

An important distinction must be made between the immediate consequences of armed conflict and the cumulative effects of prolonged instability. While military operations may cause direct casualties,

destruction and displacement, the continuation of a conflict can gradually undermine the systems upon which civilian populations depend.

For example, damage to electricity infrastructure can affect the operation of hospitals, water-treatment facilities and communication networks. Similarly, the deterioration of transportation infrastructure may prevent the delivery of essential supplies, while shortages of qualified personnel can weaken healthcare and education systems.

These consequences become particularly serious when conflict continues over several years. The International Committee of the Red Cross (2015) has emphasised that the repeated disruption of essential urban services can progressively weaken infrastructure until maintaining or repairing it becomes increasingly difficult and expensive.

Moreover, prolonged instability can produce consequences that extend beyond the duration of the conflict itself. Interrupted education may limit future employment opportunities, while persistent economic uncertainty can discourage investment and contribute to poverty. Communities may therefore continue experiencing the consequences of a conflict even after military hostilities have ceased.

This cumulative deterioration is particularly relevant to the distinction between frozen and resolved conflicts. Although the absence of large-scale military operations may reduce immediate humanitarian risks, it does not necessarily restore the economic, institutional and social conditions required for sustainable development.

The Protracted and Frozen Conflict of Northern Cyprus

The problem became what it is now after the Turkish invasion of Cyprus in 1974, which resulted in Turkish occupation of the northern one-third of the island. Despite the fact that the 1974 coup d'état served as the trigger for the Turkish invasion of Cyprus, the Turkish army did not retreat after the restoration of the legitimate government. At a later date, the Turkish Cypriots declared their independence in the form of the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus. Nevertheless, only Turkey recognises it.

But why is it still considered a protracted and frozen conflict? The answer is simple: it is called protracted because it has lasted over five decades (since the invasion in 1974), and frozen because it resulted in a military and diplomatic deadlock instead of concluding with a formal peace agreement.

The Cyprus dispute demonstrates how a prolonged conflict can gradually become embedded in the political and social structures of a divided territory. Although the absence of large-scale hostilities has contributed to relative stability, the continued division of the island has created separate administrative, economic and political arrangements that complicate the possibility of reunification.

Another important characteristic of the Cyprus dispute is the relationship between political negotiations and public acceptance. Any comprehensive settlement would require not only an

agreement between political representatives but also sufficient support from the communities directly affected by its implementation. This makes the conflict particularly difficult to resolve, since proposals considered acceptable by one community may be perceived as threatening by the other.

The case therefore illustrates that the existence of a ceasefire and relative military stability does not necessarily indicate that the underlying conflict has been resolved. Rather, a situation may remain frozen precisely because the political disagreements responsible for the original confrontation have not been addressed in a mutually acceptable manner.

Timeline of Events

October 1947	The Indo-Pakistani conflict begins after the partition of British India. The conflict is characterized by cross-border terrorism, battles and proxy warfare. The conflict is still ongoing.
1948–1973	Several Arab–Israeli wars took place involving Israel and neighbouring Arab states, including Egypt, Syria, Jordan and Iraq. Israel signed peace treaties with Egypt in 1979 and Jordan in 1994, while disputes with other regional actors remain unresolved.
1953	The Korean War between North Korea and South Korea, involving the United States and other powers, ended in an armistice rather than a peace treaty.
1956	China versus Taiwan, a self-governing island seeking wider international recognition. However China considers Taiwan as its own territory, having increased its naval and military presence in the Taiwan strait. The conflict continues and Taiwan has limited diplomatic recognition and participates under the name “Chinese Taipei” in certain international organisations and events.
1974	A war broke out between Turkey and Cyprus. Before any declaration of a ceasefire, the Turkish army entered Cyprus on July 20 and established a foothold on the island. A civilian

	government then took over when the military regime in Greece collapsed. Following the failure of peace talks, the Turks extended their initial beachhead in August 1974, occupying 36% of the territory. Known commonly as the "Green Line," the ceasefire line established in August 1974 came to be known as the United Nations Buffer Zone in Cyprus.
21 July 1992	A ceasefire agreement ended major fighting in Transnistria, but the political status of the region remained unresolved.
21 March 2014	The OSCE Special Monitoring Mission to Ukraine began operations to observe and report on the security situation and facilitate dialogue.
5 September 2014	The Minsk Protocol set out ceasefire and political measures for the conflict in eastern Ukraine, negotiated through the Trilateral Contact Group.
12 February 2015	A further package of measures (Minsk II) was agreed to implement the Minsk agreements, including a ceasefire and withdrawal of heavy weapons.
2022	Russia launched a full-scale invasion of Ukraine, escalating the conflict that began in 2014.
31 March 2022	The OSCE Special Monitoring Mission to Ukraine ended its operations after participating states could not agree to extend its mandate.

Major Actors Involved

Russia and Ukraine

The conflict between Russia and Ukraine has emerged as one of the biggest security threats to Europe within the last few decades. The Russia–Ukraine conflict was initiated when Russia occupied Crimea in 2014. Later, in 2022, Russia invaded Ukraine. There were serious humanitarian impacts of the war, such as millions of displaced people, civilian deaths, and destruction of infrastructure. The conflict

not only caused humanitarian harm but also had a global impact on security by questioning the principles of territorial integrity and sovereignty as per international law. The conflict also created tensions between Russia and other countries, especially in terms of NATO and European security.

Abkhazia and South Ossetia

The disputes involving Abkhazia and South Ossetia and Georgia are cases of frozen disputes that have been ongoing since the end of the Soviet era. In the early 1990s, these two regions had declared their independence from Georgia following a war and are still considered parts of Georgia by many countries across the globe. After the 2008 Russo-Georgian War, Russia declared its recognition of Abkhazia and South Ossetia as independent states and also took military action in both regions. This dispute has created political instability, humanitarian problems, and conflicts between Georgia and Russia.

Mainland China and Taiwan

The political disagreement between mainland China and Taiwan is considered to be one of the most delicate unresolved political disputes. According to the People's Republic of China, Taiwan is an integral part of its territory, and China is ready to use military means to resolve this dispute. However, Taiwan is self-governing, with its own government, military, and democratic system. At the same time, no major military operations have taken place between these countries. Nevertheless, there is a possibility for such development in the future as there are numerous military exercises on both sides. It is an important international matter because Taiwan is strategically located in the Indo-Pacific area and is a significant producer of semiconductors.

North Korea-South Korea

The Korean Peninsula is a case of an unresolved dispute since the Korean War of 1950 to 1953 ended with the signing of an armistice agreement and not by means of signing a peace treaty. Today both North and South Korea maintain their separate existence with the presence of powerful military contingents in the Demilitarized Zone (DMZ). This problem has significant international implications because of the nuclear program of North Korea and the participation of such major powers as the USA, China, Japan, and Russia.

Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE)

The OSCE is a crucial institution that prevents conflict, mediates, and enhances cooperation in security, especially in the European continent and the former Soviet Union area. The OSCE has played an active part in ceasefire monitoring, negotiation processes, and mechanisms for confidence building among the conflicting parties. The involvement of the OSCE in disputes like Ukraine and Georgia shows the significance of regional organizations in dispute management through diplomacy.

European Union (EU)

European Union (EU) is one of the main stakeholders in the resolution of conflicts which impact European security, especially the conflict between Russia and Ukraine as well as instability in other

adjacent regions. The involvement of the EU can be demonstrated through its assistance which includes humanitarian aid, economic aid, diplomacy and reconstruction.

Comunità di Sant'Egidio

An international Christian movement known for its involvement in humanitarian aid, dialogue, and peace mediation. Established in Italy in 1968, the organization has been involved in diplomatic activities aimed at conflict resolution using informal dialogues between the conflicting parties. One of the major successes of the Sant'Egidio Community lies in its participation in negotiations, which resulted in the 1992 Peace Agreement of Mozambique that put an end to the civil war. The main objectives of the Sant'Egidio Community involve establishment oinvolve establishing means of communicationg parties, provision of support to the process of reconciliation and assistance to vulnerable populations affected by conflicts and unrest.

The African Center for the Constructive Resolution of Disputes (ACCORD)

South African non-governmental organization that deals with conflict prevention, mediation, and peacebuilding in Africa. Formed in 1992, the organization engages with governments, regional bodies, civil civil society organisations and communitiesme up with peaceful resolutions to conflicts. Training in mediation, support of peace processes, and research on conflict management and post-conflict recovery are some of the activities undertaken by ACCORD. In its mission, ACCORD tries to address the underlying causes of conflicts, promotpromote dialogue among communitiesprevent future violence in fragile areas.

Swisspeace

An organization based in Switzerland that is committed to fostering effective peace building activities through research, training, and capacity building for conflict transformation. Founded in 1988, Swisspeace helps governments and other international actors identify different conflicts and strategies that can help in achieving sustainable peace. Some of the issues that Swisspeace works on include mediation, transitional justice, prevention of violence, and local peace building initiatives. Swisspeace has helped foster peace in several regions experiencing conflicts through its contributions in research, expertise, and capacity building.

Concordis International

Concordis International is an organization whose main activity is peace building through dialogue, mediation, and reconciliation in areas suffering from conflicts. In its work, Concordis mainly concentrates on involving conflicting parties to foster interaction and find peaceful solutions. Concordis International has taken part in peace activities in such areas as Sudan, South Sudan, and Central African Republic where it assists in local peace processes and community conflict resolution.

The organization uses an approach which states that achieving sustainable peace requires cooperation among various parties and involvement of the local community affected by conflicts. [16]

UN Documents and International Agreements

S/RES/186

Resolution 186 (1964), as a response to the deteriorating situation of security on the island, which threatens world peace and security, establishes the United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus (UNFICYP). Adopted on March 4, 1964, it states that the Government of Cyprus is to do everything possible to prevent violence and massacre, that no member state engage in any activity which will worsen the situation, and that the community and its leaders show extreme moderation.[17]

A/RES/1514

On December 14, 1960, the UN General Assembly passed the "Declaration on the Granting of Independence to Colonial Countries and Peoples" (Resolution 1514 (XV)). This document called for an end to colonial domination and the recognition of the right to freedom and self-determination for all peoples.

States could support the resolution in the General Assembly, where no member has a veto. The concept of self-determination was firmly established by international law, and it represented a milestone in the decolonization process. [18]

The Geneva Conventions (1949)

They protect people who are not, or are no longer, participating in armed conflicts and help establish legal standards for the humane treatment of non-combatants during warfare.[19]

The Helsinki Final Act

The Helsinki Final Act was adopted in 1975 to enhance détente between East and West. As it was a political agreement rather than a treaty, it was not legally binding.[20]

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[16] "The 10 Most Important NGOs Active in Conflict Transformation." *ICRP*, 1 Aug. 2021, culturalrelations.org/the-10-most-important-ngos-active-in-conflict-transformation/.

[17] UNSCR. "Resolution 186 (1964)." 1964. https://unscr.com/en/resolutions/186/

[18] McWhinney, Edward. "Declaration on the Granting of Independence to Colonial Countries and Peoples." 2008. https://legal.un.org/avl/ha/dicc/dicc.html

[19] ---. "Geneva Conventions." *Wikipedia*, Wikimedia Foundation, 30 Mar. 2019, en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Geneva_Conventions.

[20] ---. "Helsinki Accords." *Wikipedia*, Wikimedia Foundation, 4 Aug. 2019, en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Helsinki_Accord

The UNFICYP (The United Nations Peace Keeping Force in Cyprus)

The initial mandate of UNFICYP was one that involved restoring peace and creating conditions that would enable discussion to take place. The mandate was issued by the United Nations Security Council through its Resolution 186 after negotiations aimed at putting a stop to intercommunal strife were unsuccessful. After the 1974 Turkish invasion of the island that resulted in the division of the island, the mandate of the mission was further extended to include overseeing ceasefire lines and patrolling the Green Line, which acts as a buffer between the Republic of Cyprus and the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus.[21]

A/RES/72/282

According to Volodymyr Yelchenko, Permanent Representative of Ukraine at the UN, the United Nations General Assembly had called for the withdrawal of troops from the Transnistrian region of Moldova by the Russian Federation. [22]

Previous Attempts to Solve the Issue

The 5+2 format

In other terms, the main objective of the 5+2 talks is to address the problem between Moldova and the unrecognized state of Transnistria through negotiations. The latter two are known as "parties to the conflict," and the other participants in the process, such as Russia, Ukraine, and the Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe (OSCE), are known as "mediators" of the talks, whereas the US and the EU are "observers."

The Annan Plan in Cyprus (2000-2004)

In order to unify the island of Cyprus as a loose "United Cyprus Republic," the UN produced a vast, comprehensive settlement plan. It had complicated power-sharing arrangements between the Greek and Turkish Cypriot communities, as well as a rotating presidency. In a concurrent vote, Turkish Cypriots backed it, while Greek Cypriots heavily rejected it, freezing the conflict.[23]

The Minsk Agreements (2014–2015)

The Minsk Protocol of September 2014 and the February 2015 package of measures sought to end fighting in eastern Ukraine through ceasefires, withdrawal of heavy weapons and a political

[21] "United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus." *Grokipedia*, 2026, grokipedia.com/page/United_Nations_Peacekeeping_Force_in_Cyprus.

[22] "UNGA Approves Resolution on Russian Military Withdrawal from Transnistria." *Unian.info*, UNIAN, 22 June 2018, www.unian.info/politics/10162958-unga-approves-resolution-on-russian-military-withdrawal-from-transnistria.html.

[23] "The 2002-04 Annan Plan in Cyprus: An Attempted UN-Mediated Constitutional Transition. Number 27." *ConstitutionNet*, 2016, constitutionnet.org/vl/item/2002-04-annan-plan-cyprus-attempted-un-mediated-constitutional-transition-number-27.

settlement. Their implementation remained incomplete, and the agreements did not secure a lasting peace.

OSCE Mediation and Monitoring

The OSCE supported negotiations and ceasefire monitoring, including through its Special Monitoring Mission to Ukraine, which operated from March 2014 until March 2022. The OSCE also mediates in the Transnistrian settlement process through the 5+2 format, although no final political settlement has been reached.

Possible Solutions

Peacekeeping Operations

Peacekeeping operations mediate and facilitate peace agreements and help to keep their implementation on track. They help to maintain stability and dialogue between parties to a conflict that have not yet agreed on a durable peace agreement. They build trust between communities and conflict actors at the local level, linking local level mediation to national political processes and actors.[24]

Enhancement of Confidence Building Measures Among Parties Involved in the Conflict

A lack of confidence in each other is one of the key factors that make it hard to solve frozen and protracted conflicts. Confidence building measures, which are not mandatory and do not lead to quick political solutions, may help relieve tensions and lay the ground for successful negotiations. Communication hot lines, cooperation in humanitarian activities, prisoner exchanges, information exchange, demining, and joint work in areas of infrastructure and environmental protection are some of these measures.

Improving Mandates for Special Envoys and Mediation over Time

Whereas there is a need for long-term engagement in diplomacy rather than short-term interventions to solve prolonged disputes, it is possible for the United Nations to improve the effectiveness of its representatives by increasing the length of the mandates for Special Representatives and Special Envoys as well as providing adequate finances and technology, alongside continuous political support. Through the extension of the mandates, mediators can become more knowledgeable about the politics and humanitarian issues surrounding each particular dispute and create trust among the conflicting parties.

Coordinating International and Regional Organizations

Conflicts that become frozen or prolonged are typically situations where there are many international actors who have overlapping roles. Enhanced cooperation between the UN and regional organizations like OSCE, EU, AU, and ASEAN would enhance the efforts of conflict prevention,

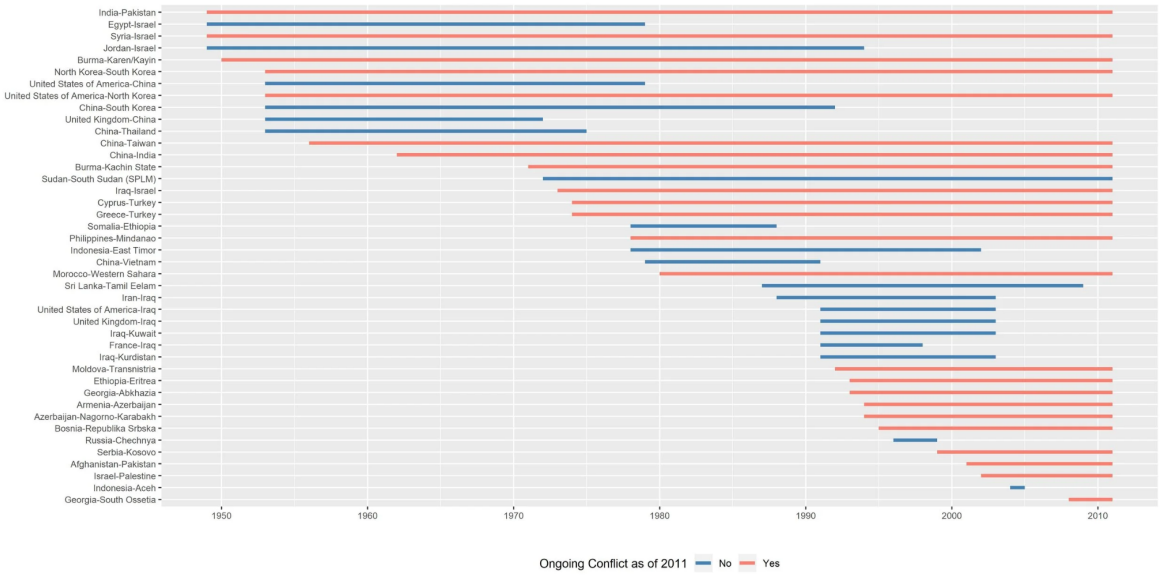
[24] "Advancing Political Solutions to Conflict." *United Nations Peacekeeping*, peacekeeping.un.org/en/advancing-political-solutions-to-conflict.

mediation, peacekeeping, and post-conflict reconstruction. Effective coordination makes it possible for these organizations to pool their resources and knowledge without duplication of efforts and create comprehensive peacebuilding strategies.[25]

Further Reading



(Fig. 2) Post-Soviet Frozen Conflicts (2019)[26]



(Fig. 3) Table of ongoing conflicts as of 2011[27]

[25] "Conflict-Solving Mechanisms and Negotiation Formats for Post-Soviet Protracted Conflicts - SCEEUS." *Sceeus*, 27 Oct. 2022, https://sceeus.se/en/publications/conflict-solving-mechanisms-and-negotiation-formats-for-post-soviet-protracted-conflicts-a-comparative-perspective/

[26] "And yet It Moves: Post-Soviet Frozen Conflicts in 2019 | ISPI." *ISPI*, 9 Dec. 2022, www.ispionline.it/en/publication/and-yet-it-moves-post-soviet-frozen-conflicts-2019-22137.

[27] University, Charles. "Peace Research Center Prague - Charles University Center of Excellence." *Peace Research Center Prague - Charles University Center of Excellence*, 2025, www.prcprague.cz/fcdataset.

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